SCHEME OF WORK

Week	Topic
1	Revision of Last Term's Work and Examination, Comprehension- Reading to grasp word meanings in various contexts., Commonly Misspelt Words, The Use of Dictionary
2	Practical Approach to Summary Writing, Comprehension: Reading for the main point. "Beauty", Vocabulary Development: Advertising, Structure: Adjuncts: explanation and Examples, Writing: Narrative Essay: Explanation, Features and Outline of a topic
3	Comprehension: Fishing in Hausa Land, Summary Writing: A Sample Passage, Vocabulary Development: Words associated with home and family life., Writing: Expository Essay: Explanation, Features and Outline of a topic, Structure: Introduction to Clauses.
4	Essay Writing: More on formal letter., Speech Work: Rhymes, Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Government and Politics.
5	Comprehension / Reading Skills: More on Skimming and Scanning., Speech work: Diphthongs /ei/ and /ai/, Structure: Conjuncts and Disjuncts.
6	Structures: Plural forms of Nouns and Compound Nouns., Speech work: Words of two syllables which are stressed on the first or second syllables, Essay Writing: Story Writing- A story which illustrates the saying- It is a man's world"
7	Comprehension and Reading Skills: Reading for leisure, Writing: Semi Formal Letter: Explanation and Features, Sentence Structure and formation., Spelling: Dropping (e) and retaining (e)

Week	Topic
8	Comprehension; Summarizing in a specified number of sentences, Speech Work: Homophones, Structure: Functions of comparatives., Vocabulary Development: Sports and Entertainment.
9	Comprehension/Reading Skills: Identifying statutory topic, theme and key sentences of a passage. Vocabulary Development: Words associated with journalism and advertising. Structure: Antonyms as words opposite in meaning and nearly opposite in meaning., Informal Letter Writing: Explanation and Features
10	Comprehension/Speaking skill. Speech work: contrasting /i/ and /i: /. Essay writing: Argumentative – Indiscipline is Responsible for the Poor Performances of Students in Examinations' , Structure: Pronoun references to the three Persons in English
11	Comprehension: Summarizing in a specified number of words. Vocabulary Development: Words associated with Building. Structure: synonyms: words nearest in meaning

COURSE CONTENT

WEEK 1

TOPIC: COMPREHENDING WORD MEANINGS IN CONTEXT; COMMONLY MISSPELT WORDS; THE USE OF DICTIONARY

Contextual Usage of Words

- Words can give various meanings in various contexts.
- For example, the word 'man' in "That man is my father" means an adult male human being. However, in "He was assigned to man the gate," 'man' means to guide or take charge.
- 'Leave' could mean to 'make', or it could mean to vacate or take a short break from work.

Commonly Misspelt Words

- Misspellings to correct: *Accomodations* -> **Accommodation**
- *Begining* -> **Beginning**
- *Clearify* -> **Clarify**
- *Continous* -> **Continuous**
- *Defiinate* -> **Definite**
- *Convenant* -> **Covenant**
- *Dilligent* -> **Diligent**
- *Auxillary* -> **Auxiliary**
- *Enimity* -> **Enmity**
- *Enviroment* -> **Environment**
- *Greatful* -> **Grateful**

The Use of Dictionary

- The dictionary is used for finding: meaning, spelling, pronunciation, usage, stress, collocation, transcription, and parts of speech/word classes.
- Example using the word 'abuse': Word class: Noun, Verb. Transcription: /əbju:s/(N), /əbju:z/(V). Meaning: misuse, unfair violent treatment, insult. Collocation: drug/alcohol/substance abuse.

WEEK 2

TOPICS: PRACTICAL APPROACH TO SUMMARY WRITING; VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: ADVERTISING; STRUCTURE: ADJUNCTS; WRITING: NARRATIVE ESSAY

Rules of Summary

- Read the passage twice or three times to ensure understanding before attempting questions.
- Answers must be as short as possible; wordiness is penalized.
- Write answers in your own words; lifting text directly is penalized.
- Avoid extraneous materials.
- Answers must be written in complete sentences and numbered (not phrases).
- Ensure answers are clear, unambiguous, and grammatically error-free.

Vocabulary Development: Advertising

- **Advertisement:** Texts, pictures, illustrations, or music used to create awareness about a product or service.
- **Target:** The group of people an advert is aimed at (e.g., children, men, students).
- **Advertising:** The process of creating awareness of a product or service.
- **Publicity:** Any material written or spoken about a product or service.
- **Market:** Those who may buy the product.
- **Branding:** The activity of giving a particular name and image to a product/goods or services.

Structure: Adjuncts

An adjunct is a type of adverb which modifies the verb by altering its meaning, answering questions like how, when, where, to what extent, or how often.

- **Manner (How?):** Well, quickly, slowly, fast.
- **Time (When?):** Now, again, lately, soon, yesterday.
- **Place (Where?):** There, near, outside, somewhere.
- **Degree (To what extent?):** Scarcely, quite, hardly, very.

- **Frequency (How often?):** Often, usually, normally.
- **Direction:** Forward, away, eastward.

Narrative Essay Features

- A narrative essay is a written account of an imaginary or real past event, requiring detailed explanation and orderly arrangement.
- Title is boldly written in capital letters.
- The past tense is heavily used.
- Events must be vividly described, chronologically arranged, and properly linked.
- Paragraphs should be embellished with figurative language or proverbs.

WEEK 3

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: INTRODUCTION TO CLAUSES; WRITING: EXPOSITORY ESSAY; VOCABULARY: HOME AND FAMILY LIFE

Structure: Introduction to Clauses

- A clause must always have a subject, a predicate, and a finite verb (which distinguishes it from a phrase).
- **Independent Clauses:** Express a complete thought and can stand alone as a sentence (e.g., "My English Master is a kind man.").
- **Dependent (Subordinate) Clauses:** Do not express a complete thought and cannot stand alone; they depend on an independent clause for meaning.
- **Noun Clause:** Performs the functions of a noun (e.g., subject: "What he said is bitter").
- **Adjectival Clause:** Modifies a noun or pronoun, often introduced by subordinating conjunctions like who, whom, whose, that, which, where, when.
- **Adverbial Clause:** Modifies the verb in the main clause by telling how, when, where, why, to what extent, or under what conditions the action is performed. Types include Manner, Time, Place, Reason, Condition, Purpose, Result, Comparison, and Concession.

Writing: Expository Essay

- Aims to instruct, inform, explain, criticize, or analyze issues to educate the reader.
- Title is boldly written in capital letters.
- Points and arguments must be logically presented.
- Paragraphs are developed with facts, examples, illustrations, and comparisons/contrasts.
- Vague ideas must be properly defined and explained.
- The present tense is generally used.

Vocabulary Development: Home and Family Life

- **Half-brother/sister:** A boy or girl who has the same mother or father as someone.
- **Grandchild:** Child of one's son or daughter.
- **Cousin:** Child of one's uncle or aunt.

- **Nephew:** Son of one's sister or brother.
- **Extended family:** Group consisting of parents, children, and other relatives like aunts, uncles, cousins, and grandparents.
- **Nuclear Family:** Family consisting only of parents and their children.
- **Home Objects:** Furniture (tables, chairs, beds), Utensils (tools for cooking), Wardrobe (cupboard for clothes), Grinder (device for crushing into powder), Blender (machine for mixing soft food into liquid), Fridge (cooling container).

WEEK 4

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: RHYMES; ESSAY WRITING: FORMAL LETTER; VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Speech Work: Rhymes

A rhyme refers to words ending with the same sequence of sounds, often used in poetry. Common pairs include:

- Should / Would
- Food / Sued
- Bird / Word
- Laugh / Calf
- Ride / Site
- Buy / Sky
- Head / Said
- Fail / Sail
- Hair / Bear
- Breeze / Please
- Know / Hoe
- Crave / Grave
- Shock / Rock

Essay Writing: Formal Letter Features

- Also known as official letters, written to people in official positions.
- **Writer's Address:** Written at the top right-hand corner of the page.
- **Receiver's Address:** Written on the left-hand side following the date.
- **Salutation:** "Dear Sir," or "Dear Madam," with a mandatory comma.
- **Heading/Title:** Comes directly after the salutation. It should be short, written entirely in capital letters, or underlined if using Title Case.
- **Body:** No pleasantries, slangs, or contracted forms. Use polite and formal language.

- **Subscript:** Ends with "Yours faithfully," followed by a signature, then the full name.

Vocabulary Development: Government and Politics

- **Government:** The system or process of governing a state.
- **Politics:** Ideas and activities concerned with gaining and using power.
- **Ballot box:** Box into which voters put their ballot paper.
- **Constituency:** Voters in a district, or the district itself.
- **Democracy:** Government run by all the people directly or through representatives.
- **Despot:** Ruler who does what he likes and oppresses the people.
- **Electoral College:** Group of people already voted in who may vote in the president.
- **Nomination:** Act of naming a candidate for a post or office.
- **Political Party:** Group or association formed to practice politics.
- **Voting Age:** Minimum age at which one is eligible to vote.
- **Election:** Occasion when people vote to choose someone for an official position.

WEEK 5

TOPICS: SKIMMING AND SCANNING; SPEECH WORK: CONTRASTING SOUNDS; STRUCTURE: NOMINALIZATION

Skimming and Scanning

- **Skimming:** Reading materials very fast to search for main ideas and the gist. Readers look for keywords, headings, and jot down salient points without deep reading.
- **Scanning:** Rapid reading specifically to locate specific words, facts, or details in a large text. Requires reading phrase by phrase with high concentration.

Speech Work: Contrasting Consonants

- **/f/ (voiceless labio-dental fricative) vs /v/ (voiced labio-dental fricative):**
  - Fine / Vine
  - Fast / Vast
  - Half / Halve
  - Life / Alive
- **/s/ (voiceless alveolar fricative) vs /z/ (voiced alveolar fricative):**
  - Sow / Zoo
  - Sip / Zip
  - Bless / Breeze
  - Rice / Rise
- **/ʃ/ (voiceless post-alveolar fricative) vs /ʒ/ (voiced post-alveolar fricative):**
  - Nation / Treasure
  - Machine / Exposure
  - Precious / Measure
  - Indication / Decision

Introduction to Nominalization

Nominalization is the conversion of other word classes into nouns. Methods include:

- **Affixation:** Using bound morphemes (prefixes, suffixes, infixes) to change word classes. Common suffixes include:
  - *-ment* (with verbs: enslave -> enslavement)
  - *-ness* (with adjectives: useful -> usefulness)
  - *-ity* (with adjectives: ethnic -> ethnicity)
  - *-hood* (with nouns/adjectives: man -> manhood)
- **Compounding:** Combining words to form a compound noun. Plurals are formed by pluralizing the major word:
  - Initial word major: Secretary-general -> Secretaries-general
  - Final word major: Headscarf -> Headscarfs
  - Both parts pluralized: Woman pilot -> Women pilots

WEEK 6

TOPICS: STRUCTURES: PREFIXES AND SUFFIXES; SPEECH WORK: SYLLABLE STRESS; ESSAY WRITING: STORY WRITING

Prefixes and Negation

- **Prefixes:**
  - *extra* (outside): extraordinary
  - *ex* (out of): ex-official
  - *inter* (between/among): inter-city
  - *trans* (across): transpose
  - *post* (after): postgraduate
  - *pre* (before): pre-natal
  - *super* (above): supernatural
  - *sub* (below): substandard
  - *anti* (against): anti-social
- **Suffixes:**
  - *Negation:* -less (childless, fatherless, heartless)
  - *Pluralization:* -ies, -es (babies, boxes)
  - *Tense/Verb creation:* -en, -ze (strengthen, deafen, mobilize)

Speech Work: Syllable Stress

- Words of two syllables stressed on the first syllable: BAsic, SOLemn, CREDit, COLLar, CHRIStian, CERtain, FORtune, HATred, CAPtain.
- **Exceptions:**
  - Words containing a prefix are stressed on the second syllable (e.g., beGIN, beTWEEN, inFORM, deSPITE).
  - Words that double as a noun and verb: First syllable is stressed for nouns (CONsent), second syllable for verbs (conSENT).

Essay Writing: Story Writing

- Story writing requires imagination and an orderly timeline of events, moving gradually to the climax.
- Frequent use of the simple past tense is required since the account relates to past events (e.g., 'he wrote', 'they thought').

WEEK 7

TOPICS: SENTENCE STRUCTURE AND FORMATION; SPELLING: DROPPING AND RETAINING 'E'

Types of Sentences According to Structure

- **Simple sentence:** Contains only one clause.
- **Compound sentence:** Contains two main clauses linked by a coordinating conjunction ('and', 'but', 'or').
- **Multiple sentence:** Contains more than two main clauses linked by coordinating conjunctions.
- **Complex sentence:** Contains one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses.
- **Compound-Complex sentence:** Contains more than one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses.

Elements of Sentence Structure

A sentence possesses five key units: Subject (S), Verb (V), Object (O), Complement (C), and Adjunct/Adverbial (A).

- **Subject:** The person or thing the sentence is about.
- **Predicate:** Indicates what is said about the subject, including the verb and its modifiers.
- **Object:** Direct object receives the action. Indirect object precedes the direct object (e.g., "He buys *me* lovely shoes").
- **Complement:** Provides more info about the subject (Subjective: "The girl is *kind*") or object (Objective: "They called Joseph a *mad man*").
- **Adjunct:** Words acting as an adverb modifying the verb (e.g., "The girl is *in the room*").

Spelling: Dropping and Retaining 'e'

- Drop 'e' before suffixes starting with a vowel (e.g., continue -> continuous; write -> writing).
- Retain 'e' before suffixes starting with a consonant (e.g., move -> movement; love -> loved).
- Retain 'e' to keep 'c' and 'g' sounding soft (e.g., notice -> noticeable; trace -> traceable).

- Retain 'e' to avoid confusion with similar words (e.g., age -> ageing).

WEEK 8

TOPICS: COMPREHENSION: SUMMARIZING; SPEECH WORK: INTONATION; STRUCTURE: FUNCTIONS OF COMPARATIVES

Guide to Summarizing in Specified Sentences

- Identify the main idea or argument of the passage.
- Use your own words without distorting the meaning or writer's facts.
- Answers must be as short as possible (brevity is the essence of summary).
- Write in numbered sentences (not phrases) on separate lines, avoiding joining two points in one sentence.

Speech Work: Intonation

- Polite requests require a rising intonation (e.g., "May I see your passport please?").
- Simple greetings attract quick responses (e.g., "Good morning" -> "Morning").

Functions of Comparatives

- Comparatives are the second degree of comparison of adjectives, expressing a higher degree of a quality by comparing two things.
- **Regular Comparatives:** Add 'er' for short words (poor -> poorer; big -> bigger) or add 'more' for longer words (more expensive; more handsome).
- Decreased degrees use 'less' (strong -> less strong; worthy -> less worthy).
- **Irregular Comparatives:** Change the whole word (good -> better; bad -> worse; little -> less; far -> farther).

WEEK 9

TOPICS: COMPREHENSION: STATUTORY TOPIC, THEME, AND KEY SENTENCES; VOCABULARY: JOURNALISM AND ADVERTISING; STRUCTURE: ANTONYMS

Reading Components

- **Statutory Topic:** The fixed, overarching topic or subject area for a passage (e.g., Law, Journalism, Fishery).
- **Theme:** The specific subject or main idea of the passage.
- **Key Sentences:** Topic sentences containing the main idea of a specific paragraph.

Vocabulary Development: Journalism and Advertising

- **Mass Media:** Means of communication (TV, radio, newspapers) that reach large numbers of people.
- **Journalism:** The profession of collecting, writing, and publishing news.
- **Press Conference:** An interview for reporters given by a politician or public figure.
- **Press Gallery:** An area for newspaper reporters, especially in a legislative assembly.
- **Advertisement:** Any public announcement designed to sell goods or publicize an event.
- **Commercial:** A radio or TV advertisement paid for by a sponsor.
- **Copy-writer:** A person who writes the words contained in an advert.
- **Mass communication:** The art of reaching a great number of people with information simultaneously.

Structure: Antonyms

Antonyms are words with opposite meanings. They are formed in different ways:

- **Completely different forms:** fertile/barren; friend/enemy; opaque/transparent.
- **Adding a prefix:** adequate/inadequate; loyal/disloyal; regular/irregular.
- **Changing the prefix:** ascend/descend; export/import; construction/destruction.
- **Adding suffixes (like -less):** cheerful/cheerless; pitiful/pitiless.

WEEK 10

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: CONTRASTING /I/ AND /I:/; ESSAY WRITING: ARGUMENTATIVE

Speech Work: Contrasting Vowels

- **/I/ (Short Vowel):**
  - Hit
  - Hill
  - Sit
  - Sin
  - Dip
  - Fill
- **/i:/ (Long Vowel):**
  - Heat
  - Heel
  - Seat
  - Seen
  - Deep
  - Feel

Essay Writing: Argumentative Outline

- Write your topic clearly.
- Do not include greetings (unless it is explicitly a debate format).
- Provide a clear, intelligent definition of the subject of discussion in the introduction.
- Develop your arguments sequentially in the following paragraphs.
- Conclude your argument decisively in the last paragraph.

WEEK 11

TOPICS: COMPREHENSION: SUMMARIZING IN WORDS; VOCABULARY: BUILDING; STRUCTURE: SYNONYMS

Summarizing in a Specified Number of Words

- Your summary must not exceed the specified word count; brevity is key.
- A whole passage may be paraphrased into a single paragraph or two.
- Lists of items can be collapsed into a single umbrella term. For example, summarizing pepper, tomatoes, onion, salt, oil into "soup ingredients", or summarizing lipstick, powder, eye pencil into "cosmetics".

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Building

- A building has two main parts: the **substructure** (underground foundation) and the **superstructure** (above ground).
- **Concrete:** Mixture of cement, sand, gravel, and water used for foundations.
- **Glazier:** Person who puts glass in windows.
- **Gravel:** Pebbles and pieces of rock coarser than sand.
- **Scaffold:** Temporary elevated platform for holding workmen and materials during construction.
- **Masonry:** Skill of preparing and fixing stones in a building.
- **Architect:** Person who plans new buildings and oversees construction.
- **Cistern:** Storage tank for water as part of the toilet flush system.
- **Plumber:** Person who fits and repairs water pipes and bathroom articles.

Structure: Synonyms

A synonym is a word with nearly the same meaning as another, used to avoid monotony in writing. Note the different shades of meaning:

- **Aroma:** A pungent, spicy odour (e.g., aroma of peppers).
- **Fragrance:** A sweet and agreeable smell (e.g., fragrance of roses).
- **Stench:** An offensive, foul smell (e.g., burning rubber).
- *Other Typical Synonyms:*

- Confess -> admit, own
- Abandon -> give up, relinquish
- Dangerous -> risky, perilous
- Expensive -> dear, costly
- Disaster -> misfortune, calamity
- Dishonest -> unjust, deceptive
- Generous -> liberal, open-handed
- Famous -> renowned, eminent